

every race and by a substantial amount.

However, let's think of the general market as supporting the move in the stock. If the market drops by 2% or 9%, then that drop will help pull down a stock showing an extended V-top.

Days to ultimate high or low. Notice that it takes 45 days to drop 18% in bull markets but nearly the same time (42 days) to drop 26% in bear markets. In other words, price drops 50% faster in bear markets than in bull ones. Therefore, you'll want to short in bear markets so you can get into trouble faster.

How many change trend? I define a trend change as a move of more than 20% from the breakout. This item measures how many patterns see price drop more than 20%. In bear markets, over half the patterns will drop that far, which is terrific. Bull markets suffer, though, with just over a third seeing price drop more than 20% on the way to the ultimate low.

[Table 72.3](#) shows failure rates that I mentioned in the Focus on Failures section earlier. The numbers are cumulative. For example, I found that 183 or 15% of the patterns I looked at (in bull markets) failed to see price drop more than 5%. Another 241, when combined with the prior row's 183, totals 35% of extended V-tops that will see price fail to drop more than 10% after a downward breakout.